



ENGL 206 Section B1
How Poems Work: Introduction to Poetry
Winter Term 2023

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Office Hours: Zoom: Wednesdays 1:00-2:00 <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/6354152761>

In Person: Fridays 11:00-12:00 HC 3-29

Course Location, Days & Time: Tuesday & Thursday 2:00-3:20, TB 108

The University of Alberta acknowledges that we are located on Treaty 6 territory, and respects the histories, languages, and cultures of the First Nations, Métis, Inuit, and all First Peoples of Canada, whose presence continues to enrich our vibrant community.

Course Description: This course will provide an introduction to a diverse range of poets and poetries with a focus on poetic forms, modes of production and circulation, and contexts of reception in order to think about ways poetry produces meaning and value. We'll read some conventional and canonical poetry alongside innovative and experimental works, examples of poetry in popular culture and various media, and we'll do so with an attention to the work of creative individuals across diverse cultures, histories, and geographies. We'll develop some terminology for talking about poetry, and we'll explore strategies for thinking about poetic meaning and where, and how, it might be located.

Reading Schedule:

Please see eClass for details on our reading schedule.

Assignments and Weighting:

Component	Weighting	Date
Participation	10%	Ongoing
In-Class Writing Assignments	5%	Ongoing
Midterm Examination	20%	Thursday, February 16
Poetry Reading Report	20%	Thursday, March 2
Close Listening Exercise	20%	Thursday, March 16
Research Paper (1500 wds)	25%	Thursday, March 30

Participation

The 10% grade assigned to participation is based on evident preparation for class, completion of tasks during class, and contributions to group work and class discussion.

In-Class Writing Assignments

Students will be called upon to do some low-stakes in-class handwriting on five unscheduled occasions during the term. The work will be submitted for review (but not grading), and each submission is worth 1% of the 5% allotted to in-class writing assignments. If you miss one of these days without a valid excuse, the marks cannot be regained.

Midterm Examination

For this assignment, you'll sit a Midterm Examination on Thursday, February 16 during regular class time. You'll be asked to read and analyze a short poem using some of the reading strategies and terminology we've modelled and developed so far. The answer will consist of a 500-750 word hand-written essay requiring careful close reading and analysis of a single poem, without the use of secondary sources. You'll have several poems from which to choose, none of which we will have previously considered.

Poetry Reading Report

Students will be required to attend one poetry reading on campus, off campus, or virtually and reflect on that event in the form of a 250 word written report. Each week, in person and on eClass, the instructor will advise students of upcoming poetry readings to provide multiple opportunities to fulfill this assignment. In the report, the student will be asked to consider any relevant aspect of the event (venue, audience composition and response, poet's performance style, the materials performed) in evaluating the experience of that particular poetry reading. Reports will not be accepted after Thursday, March 2.

Close Listening Exercise

For this assignment, you'll be asked to select one of a number of short recorded poetry performances, listen closely (and perhaps repeatedly) to that recording, and reflect on a number of questions, or prompts, designed to get you thinking about the difference between experiencing the poem in print and experiencing the poem aurally. We'll consider how the poem shifts in emphasis and meaning from the page to the stage, how a listening audience differs from a reading audience, and what listening might tell us that reading does not. This 500 word assignment will be due on Thursday, March 16.

Research Paper

Topics for the research paper will be distributed at the beginning of March. The assignment will be due on Thursday, March 30. The essay will be 1500 words in length and will require the use of a minimum of two secondary sources in addition to your primary text(s).

Grading:

The final exam is worth 30% of your final grade; the term work noted above will constitute 70% of your final grade.

The final exam is scheduled for Monday, April 17 @ 9:00am-11:00am. TB 108.

Assignments and the Final Exam will be evaluated in the form of a percentage grade. Percentage grades in University of Alberta English classes are translated into letter grades according to the following schema:

Excellent	A+	4.0	96-100
	A	4.0	91-95
	A-	3.7	86-90
Good	B+	3.3	81-85
	B	3.0	76-80
	B-	2.7	72-75
Satisfactory	C+	2.3	68-71
	C	2.0	63-67
	C-	1.7	59-62
Poor	D+	1.3	55-58
Minimal Pass	D	1.0	50-54
Fail	F	0.0	0-49

Policy for Submissions and Late Assignments:

Late Assignments:

The Poetry Reading Report, Close Listening Exercise, and Research Paper must be submitted through eClass by midnight on the date assigned. Late assignments will be subject to a 5% reduction for each day or partial day of late submission, including weekends. Exceptions will only be made if the student provides an *acceptable* explanation and *advance* notice of the delay.

Deferral of term work is a privilege and not a right; there is no guarantee that a deferral will be granted. Misrepresentation of Facts to gain a deferral is a serious breach of the [Code of Student Behaviour](#).

Deferred Final Examination: For information on how to apply for a deferred exam see ["I Missed my Final Exam, Now What?"](#)

Student Responsibilities

Academic Integrity: The University of Alberta is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are expected to be familiar with these standards regarding academic honesty and to uphold the policies of the University in this respect. Students are particularly urged to familiarize themselves with the provisions of the [Code of Student Behaviour](#) (COSB) and avoid any behaviour that could potentially result in suspicions of cheating, plagiarism, misrepresentation of facts and/or participation in an offence. Academic dishonesty is a serious offence and can result in suspension or expulsion from the University. Instructors are required to report suspicion of violations to the COSB where investigation and disciplinary action will follow. See the [Academic Discipline Process](#).

All students should consult [the Academic Integrity website](#). If you have any questions, ask your instructor.

Plagiarism: plagiarism is the unacknowledged incorporation of work that is not your own in an assignment that is submitted under your name: keep in mind that plagiarism includes the uncited quotation of work that is not your own, even if it is only a matter of a few words or sentences; the paraphrasing or rewording of work that is not your own; the inclusion of work in another writer's words, even when its information seems to be "common knowledge"; and, of course, the submission of an essay that has not been written by you. Plagiarism is a serious matter, and students are reminded to attend to careful quotation and documentation in their written work and to be aware of the hazards of too much help from tutors.

Recording of Lectures: Audio or video recording, digital or otherwise, of lectures, labs, seminars or any other teaching environment by students is allowed only with the prior written consent of the instructor or as a part of an approved accommodation plan. Student or instructor content, digital or otherwise, created and/or used within the context of the course is to be used solely for personal study, and is not to be used or distributed for any other purpose without prior written consent from the content author(s).

Ensuring a Positive Learning Environment

The Faculty of Arts is committed to ensuring that all students, faculty and staff are able to work and study in an environment that is safe and free from discrimination and harassment. It does not tolerate behaviour that undermines that environment.

If you are experiencing harassment, discrimination, fraud, theft or any other issue and would like to get confidential advice, please contact any of these campus services:

- [Office of Safe Disclosure & Human Rights](#): *A safe, neutral and confidential space to disclose concerns about how the University of Alberta policies, procedures or ethical standards are being applied. They provide strategic advice and referral on matters such as discrimination, harassment, duty to accommodate and wrong-doings. Disclosures can be made in person or online using the [Online Reporting Tool](#)*
- [University of Alberta Protective Services](#): *Peace officers dedicated to ensuring the safety and security of U of A campuses and community. Staff or students can contact UAPS to make a report if they feel unsafe, threatened, or targeted on campus or by another member of the university community*
- [Office of the Student Ombuds](#): *A confidential and free service that strives to ensure that university processes related to students operate as fairly as possible. They offer information, advice, and support to students, faculty, and staff as they deal with academic, discipline, interpersonal, and financial issues related to student programs.*
- [Sexual Violence Supports](#): - It is the [policy](#) of the University of Alberta that sexual violence committed by any member of the University community is prohibited and constitutes misconduct.
- [Discrimination, Harassment and Duty to Accommodate policy](#), the Office of the Dean of Students coordinates academic accommodations for prospective and current students with documented disabilities affecting mobility, vision, hearing, learning, and physical or mental health. The provision of academic accommodations helps to remove structural

barriers that these students encounter in academic environments in order to facilitate equivalent learning opportunities for these students. [Academic Accommodations](#) promotes an accessible, inclusive, and universally-designed environment at the University of Alberta.

Student Resources

[The Student Service Centre](#) provides students with information and access to services to support academic, financial, mental, and physical well-being.

[The Academic Success Centre](#) (ASC) provides professional and peer-based academic support in the areas of communication, learning, and writing. They offer advising, group workshops, and online courses to students in all University of Alberta programs, and at all levels of achievement and study.

The ASC also coordinates academic accommodations for students on the grounds of disability as per the University of Alberta's [Duty to Accommodate](#) procedure. To that end, they work with students to coordinate disability-related accommodation needs for participation in University programs. For more information, and to register for services, visit the [Academic Accommodations](#) webpage.

Writing support for University of Alberta students is now offered through Writing Services under the umbrella of the ASC. Undergraduate students can work with a peer tutor to get feedback on a draft of their paper. Graduate students can book an appointment with a graduate writing advisor to get feedback on their documents. For more information, please visit the [Writing Services](#) webpage.

[First Peoples' House](#) provides an environment of empowerment for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit learners to achieve personal and academic growth.

[Health and Wellness Support for Students](#) outlines available mental and physical health resources which are offered on-campus and in the community.

[The Office of the Student Ombuds](#) is a confidential service that strives to ensure that university processes related to students operate as fairly as possible. They offer information, advice, and support to students, faculty, and staff as they deal with academic, discipline, interpersonal, and financial issues related to student programs.

[Need Help Now](#) webpage offers contact information for a variety of supports if you are in immediate need of mental health and wellness support. One can also call the 24-hour Distress Line: 780-482-4357 (HELP)

Disclaimer: Any typographical errors in this syllabus are subject to change and will be announced in class and posted on eClass. The date of the final examination is set by the Registrar and takes precedence over the final examination date reported in this syllabus.

Policy about course outlines can be found in the Evaluation Procedures and Grading System section of the University Calendar.

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